

Oxygen Group

Some scientists say this might be the first group in the periodic table with no metallic members. There are three non-metals: oxygen, sulfur, and selenium. Tellurium and polonium are semi-metals, although polonium is sometimes classified as a metal. No one yet knows the nature of livermorium, an artificial element.

Combustion

The chemical reaction that causes burning is called combustion. Of the elements in this group, only oxygen plays a key role in this process. It occurs when pure oxygen bonds to other elements, releasing heat and light in the process. Combustion usually requires heat (to start it) and fuels, which are substances that burn easily, such as wood and oil.

Wood burns in a bonfire

